Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Redevelopment Commission November 12th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L1xQn0QrM3s
Publication Date	2026-11-13T05:28:16Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: November 12, 2026
Body: Delaware County Redevelopment Commission (DCRC)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the November 12, 2026 meeting of the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission to order 00:05:08.
- **Attendance:**
  - Members Present: Brandt, Henry, Wiggerly, Green.
  - Members Absent: Mr. Keysling (out of town on business).
  - Presiding Officer: Explicitly identified as the President/Chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
  - Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance 00:05:13.

    - A moment of silence was observed in remembrance of Delaware County Sheriff's Office Corporal Blake Reynolds, who was lost in the line of duty one year ago today 00:05:35.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
    - The minutes from the October 8, 2026 meeting were approved with a correction noting Mr. Keysling's absence 00:06:19.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via roll call vote (`Brand: Yes, Henry: Yes, Wiggerly: Yes, Green: Yes`) 00:06:35.

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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:06:45 **Baker Tilly Tiff Debt Capacity Results**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Eckerley, Baker Tilly Municipal Advisors.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Matt Eckerley presented an analysis dated November 10 regarding the DCRC's capacity to issue bonds payable from tax increment (Tiff) revenues. Eckerley emphasized this was an evaluation of tools in the toolbox rather than an active proposal or recommendation to issue debt. Focus was placed on four allocation areas within the Industria Center Economic Development Area (Industrial Center, North Industria, Magna, and Midwest Metals) due to sufficient revenues and no outstanding obligations. Two illustrative scenarios were presented based on 2027 assessed values (assuming no future growth):
        - *Scenario 1 (Lease Bonds with Property Tax Backup):* Illustrative issuance of ~$15.3 million (~$13.3 million for projects), backed by a redevelopment authority lease and a countywide property tax backup, assuming 125% revenue coverage.
        - *Scenario 2 (Pure Tiff Revenue Pledge):* Illustrative issuance of ~$9.99 million (~$8.59 million for projects) relying solely on Tiff revenues with 200% revenue coverage.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation only; no formal board action taken.
- 00:29:19 **2027 RDC Spending Plan (DLGF Requirement)**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Eckerley & Commission Members.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion concerning the annual statutory requirement to approve and upload a 2027 spending plan to the Gateway online system prior to December 1st. Totaling roughly $12.38 million in its current template iteration, the plan covers scheduled 2027 bond payments and allowable statutory expenditures. Counsel confirmed the plan can be amended dynamically throughout the year as projects or debt issuances materialize.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved to set up and submit the baseline plan with future detailed amendments. Approved by roll call vote (`Brand: Yes, Henry: Yes, Green: Yes`) 00:41:28.
- 00:41:44 **Delaware County Highway Department Guardrail, Striping, and Signage Request**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dean and Tommy, Delaware County Highway Department.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** The Highway Department requested $400,000 to bring countywide guardrails ($250,000 for ~5,500 ft), striping ($100,000 for ~35 miles), and specialty signage/flashing stop signs ($50,000) up to acceptable INDOT standards. Work is anticipated to begin in early 2027 and conclude by year's end.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved to fund out of specific Tiff funds (Fountain Square / CampAC, Progress Rail, Morrison Road, Magna Tiff, and potentially Creed Tiff districts once location details are finalized). Approved by roll call vote (`Brand: Yes, Wiggerly: Yes, Green: Yes`) 00:47:52.
- 00:48:04 **Park One Second Entrance Update**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tommy, Highway Department.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Update provided on the Park One entrance project at routes 332 and 69. The project is largely complete, though outstanding punch list items are being coordinated with INDOT. The contractor agreed regarding misalignments on the plan; the median will be removed, and stop bars/traffic loops moved back. U-turns will be officially disallowed and signed accordingly.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update only; no vote taken.
- 00:53:51 **Southtown Road Property Scoring Rubric & Cowan Road Economic Development Agreement**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tracy & Commission Members.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff noted only one response was received regarding the newly created economic development scoring rubric. Discussion transitioned to item eight (Economic Development Agreement for the Cowan Road property / Equipment Share project offering $645,000). The agreement is currently under review by company attorneys, and site boundaries/legal descriptions require finalization. The commission discussed conveyance options, reaching consensus to transfer the property through a nonprofit corporation (Economic Development Alliance) to retain project control and pass proceeds back to the RDC while charging only legal fees.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
        - Item 7 (Scoring Rubric/EDA discussion) tabled. Approved via voice vote 01:01:16.

        - Motion to utilize the nonprofit transfer method for the Cowan Road property. Approved by roll call vote (`Brand: Yes, Green: Yes`) 01:42:30.
- 01:04:39 **Resolution 2026-021: Yorktown Fire Department Turnout Gear**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership / Tracy.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of a revised resolution providing $62,250 evenly distributed across three allocation areas (Magna, Morrison Road, and Fountain Square) to the Yorktown Fire Department to help purchase 50 sets of turnout gear (with the remaining $200,000 covered by the fire department's budget).
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (`Brand: Yes, Henry: Yes, Green: Yes`) 01:05:29.
- 01:06:04 **Yorktown Interlocal Agreement Amendment**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership / Tracy.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Amendment revising the $300,000 payment structure to Yorktown, distributing it across remaining annual payments (raising the next yearly payment to $375,000 through July 2030). A minor date correction from July 1 to July 6 was noted for the draft.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with the date modification. Approved by roll call vote (`Brand: Yes, Wiggerly: Yes, Green: Yes`) 01:07:09.
- 01:07:18 **Approval of Invoices / Claims**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commission Members & Auditor's Office.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of claims and administrative transitions due to project manager Gina's resignation. Tracy stepping in requires VIP system training and IT/VPN setup. A discrepancy was found on a DCCM (formerly RQAW) claim for Bridge 51, where an added $340 brought the total to $748 instead of $408. A question was also raised regarding an individual invoice for Richard Meyers ($4,200) for concrete work, with a board preference for LLC invoicing moving forward.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Claims approved for a total of $153,692.20, subject to verification of the DCCM/RQAW payment history (adjusting to $153,352.20 if already paid). Approved by roll call vote 01:15:01.

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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 01:15:41 **Ricky Green (Newsman and Author):** Commented on the lack of explicit context linking debt service analyses to specific incoming business/industry projects, noting existing county debt levels on Gateway. Criticized the spending plan process for

lacking detailed focus on business attraction and predicted radical changes in tax distribution under future legislative budgets.

- 01:17:58 **Scott Matson (Chief, Cal [Yorktown] Fire Department):** Addressed the commission regarding ongoing equipment funding needs. Highlighted an opportunity to acquire 20 lightly used MSA breathing air packs, bottles, spare batteries, chargers, and face pieces from Liberty Township for $60,000 (valued at ~$171,000 new) to outfit department apparatus for internal structure fires. Board noted the item will be formally added to the December 10 agenda.

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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - **Project Manager / Contract:** The DCRC voted to extend redevelopment services with the Economic Development Alliance on a month-to-month basis starting January 1st, 2027, pending future board structure updates (`Henry: Yes, Wiggerly: Yes, Green: Yes`) 01:42:30. Job descriptions will be circulated among commissioners.
  - **Project Updates:** Updates noted on the MIC trail gap on Cowan Road (waiting on VS Engineering), 9175 Innovation Drive real estate appraisal ($850,000 benchmark), Living Green building property taxes confirmed paid, and Nordtech aluminum trailers confirmed to present at December's meeting.
  - **Next Meeting:** Scheduled for **December 10, 2026, at 9:00 AM**.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn carried unanimously 01:28:07.

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